

Lifelong Learning Policy for Higher Education — Main Policy

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This main policy gives effect to Lifelong Learning Policy for Higher Education and covers the purposes, responsibilities and operating expectations associated with Lifelong Learning. It should be read alongside supporting guidance and any subsequent circulars.

Background and Scope

The policy landscape has evolved considerably in recent years, and institutions under Higher Education Department have responded with renewed attention to Lifelong Learning, Continuing Education, Adult Education. This main policy provides the framework needed to guide consistent practice across the sector.

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Object and Purpose

This main policy is intended to translate the objectives of Lifelong Learning Policy for Higher Education into actionable direction for institutions, officials and other stakeholders, ensuring that Lifelong Learning is pursued in a structured and accountable manner.

The purpose of this document is to establish a consistent basis for Lifelong Learning, Continuing Education across Higher Education Department-affiliated institutions, to clarify responsibilities, and to define the outcomes expected of every stakeholder.

Goals

In pursuing these objectives, Higher Education Department intends to create conditions in which institutions can deliver consistent, high-quality outcomes in respect of Lifelong Learning, Continuing Education, Adult Education, with clear lines of accountability.

This document seeks to enhance institutional capacity for Lifelong Learning, Continuing Education, promote transparency in decision-making, and ensure that resources committed to related initiatives are used effectively.

Coverage

The provisions apply to all universities and colleges under Higher Education Department. Sector partners, including employers and professional bodies, are expected to support implementation within their respective spheres.

Applicable across the full range of institutions governed by Higher Education Department, the document addresses planning, delivery, resourcing and evaluation, and may be supplemented by operational guidance issued subsequently.

Principal Provisions

The document mandates periodic self-assessment against Lifelong Learning, disclosure of material information to Higher Education Department, and corrective action where institutional performance falls short of the stated expectations.

Key provisions establish minimum standards for Lifelong Learning, define the responsibilities of institutional leadership, and require documented arrangements for Continuing Education.

Implementation Framework

Implementation will proceed through phased institutional adoption, supported by professional development, shared guidance and a common reporting calendar established by Higher Education Department.

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Roles and Responsibilities

Higher Education Department provides policy direction, capacity support and performance oversight, while institutions translate the framework into operational practice and maintain day-to-day accountability.

Clear allocation of responsibility is expected at institutional level, with Higher Education Department acting as the coordinating authority for evaluation, escalation and cross-institutional learning.

Monitoring Arrangements

Higher Education Department will review implementation against agreed indicators, publish consolidated outcomes, and engage institutions that require additional support or show exemplary practice.

Closing Note

This document is designed to evolve with institutional experience. Feedback from stakeholders will shape refinements, ensuring that the framework remains practical, proportionate and fit for purpose.